HOW-TO GUIDE

Amenity Map Maker

Turn a list of nearby places into a branded, interactive map you can share with brokers and clients, embed on a property site, or bring back into BAM and Google Earth.

Open the Map Maker → norcal-ccg.github.io/mapGenerator

From list to live map in five steps

1. **Get your data**
   Export from BAM 2.0, ask Copilot, or fill in the template.
2. **Load it**
   Drop the file in, or paste rows copied from Excel.
3. **Check & edit**
   Fix names, add places, drag pins to the right spot.
4. **Make it yours**
   Sidebar or button layout, colors, icons, fonts, transit.
5. **Save & share**
   One click makes a clean map file to send or embed.

Shareable map (.html)
Opens in any browser, with no login needed. Viewers can't edit it.

CSV
Name, category, address, coordinates and website, for Excel or Google Earth.

CSV for BAM 2.0
Same data with BAM's column names, ready to import.

STEP 1

Get your data

The tool reads a simple spreadsheet: one row per place. There are three easy ways to get one.

A. Export from BAM 2.0

Export your property list from BAM as a CSV or Excel file and drop it straight in. The tool recognizes BAM's columns (`Property Name`, `Address`, `Lat`, `Long`). Named BAM groups become categories, and generic ones like "Group 1" are ignored, so you get a clean list. BAM doesn't mark which row is your building, so the tool will ask you to pick it.

B. Ask Copilot

Paste this into Copilot (the same prompt is under *"Don't have data yet?"* in the tool, with a Copy button). Change the parts in [brackets]. Swap or add categories to fit the market, like Parking or Corporate Neighbors.

> Make me a downloadable CSV file of amenities within a [15-minute walk] of [Property Name, full street address].
>
> Use these exact column headers, in this order: Name, Category, Address, Latitude, Longitude, Website
>
> • First row: the property itself, with Category = Subject Property
> • Categories (use these exact names): [Café, Restaurant, Fitness, Hotel, Retail]
> • Up to [10] places per category, closest first
> • Latitude and Longitude to 6 decimal places, pinpointing the actual business, not the street or neighborhood
> • Only include places that are currently open and that you can verify; leave anything you can't verify out and list it separately
> • Website = the official homepage; leave it blank if there isn't one. Never guess a URL.

AI makes mistakes with locations. Copilot's coordinates are a starting point, not gospel. Always spot-check the pins before a map goes to a client (see the checklist on the last page).

C. Fill in the blank template

Click **Download blank CSV template** in the tool, fill it in with Excel, then **File → Save As → CSV UTF-8**. The plain "CSV" option can garble accented names like *Café*.

The columns

Column	Required?	Notes
Name	Yes	Also accepts *Property Name*, *Business Name*...
Latitude / Longitude	Yes	Also accepts *Lat* / *Long*. Rows without them are skipped and listed in the sidebar.
Category	Recommended	Any name works. Spell it the same way on every row: "Cafe" and "Coffee" become two groups. Also accepts *Group Name*.
Address	Recommended	Shown in each place's popup. City, State and ZIP columns get added automatically.
Website	Optional	Adds a "Website" link to the popup.

Your building goes on one row with Category `Subject Property`. If it's missing, the tool simply asks which row it is.

STEPS 2 & 3

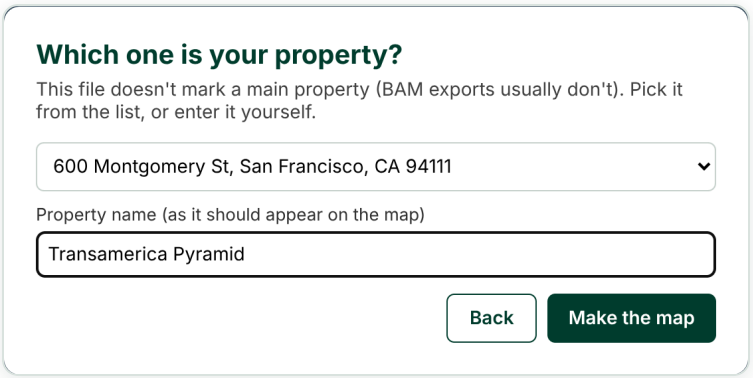
Load and fine-tune

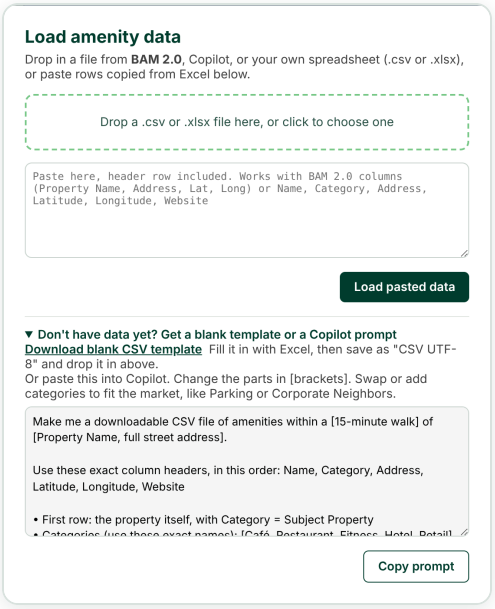
Load your file

Drag your file onto the upload box (or click it to browse), or paste rows copied from Excel and click **Load pasted data**. Excel (.xlsx) and maps you saved earlier (.html) work too.

Pick your property (BAM files)

If the file doesn't mark your building, choose it from the list and give it the name you want on the map. Not in the file? Pick *"enter it myself."*

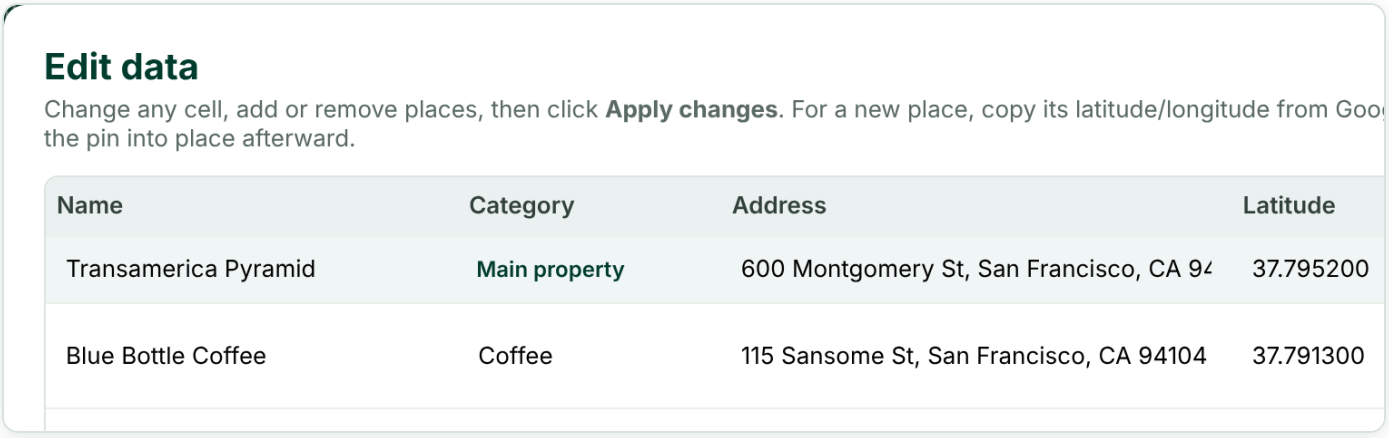




The upload window. The fold-out section has the template and the Copilot prompt.

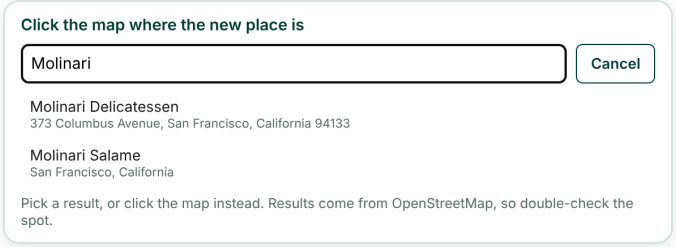
Edit data

Click **Edit data** to open everything as a table. Change any cell, rename the property, remove a place with ×, then click **Apply changes**. Rows missing a name or coordinates are highlighted instead of breaking anything. **Pin a little off?** While editing, just drag it on the map to the right spot.



Add a place without looking up coordinates

+ Add a place takes you to the map. **Search** for the business or address and pick a result, or just **click the spot** on the map. The name, address and coordinates fill in for you; add the category and website. Every row also has a **📍 Place** button to re-place it the same way.



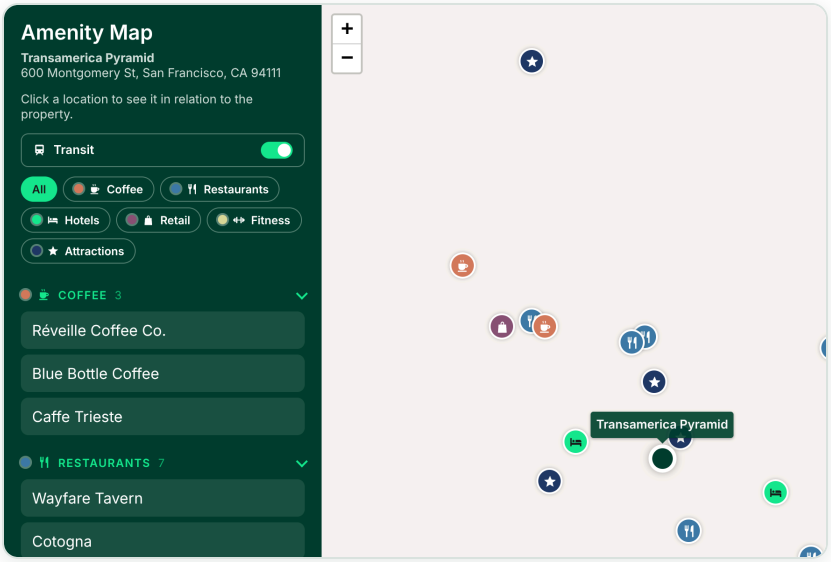
Search results come from OpenStreetMap. Clicking the map always works as a backup.

STEP 4 · MAKE IT YOURS

Start by choosing a layout

TWO LOOKS In Customize look, the first option is **Layout**. Pick **Sidebar menu** or **Button menu**. You can switch any time; everything else (colors, icons, transit) works in both.

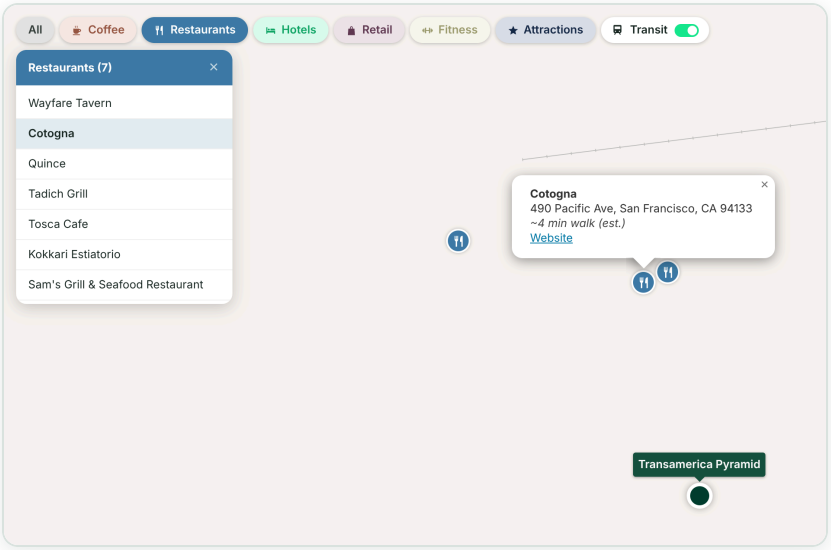
Sidebar menu



A branded panel on the left with the property name, category filters and every place listed by category.

Best for: full-page maps, presentations, and when you want your logo and title front and center.

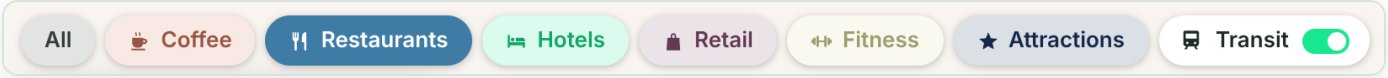
Button menu



A full-width map with category **pills** floating in the top-left. Tapping a pill shows only that category and opens a compact list; click a name to zoom to it. **All** resets the view.

Best for: embedding in property websites (Vev), smaller spaces, and a cleaner, map-first look.

Up close: the category pills (selected pill shown in solid color)

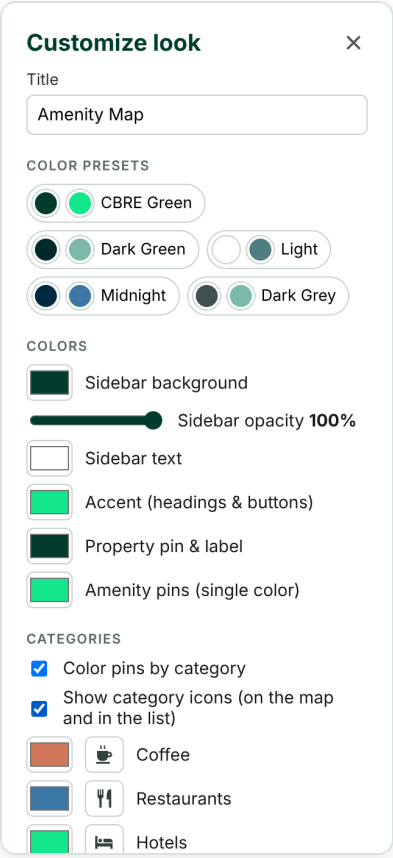


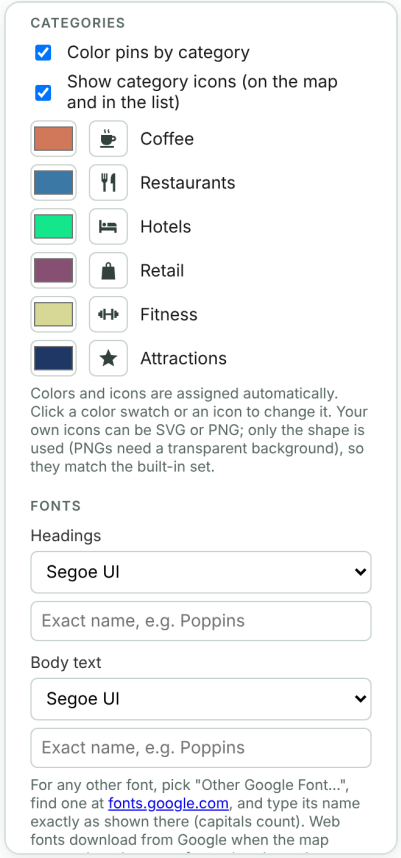
While you're editing in Button menu, the editing tools live in a small **Editing tools** panel in the bottom-left corner. Saved maps hide it.

STEP 4 · CONTINUED

Make it yours

Click **Customize look**. Every change shows on the map right away and is saved into the shareable map.





Look & brand

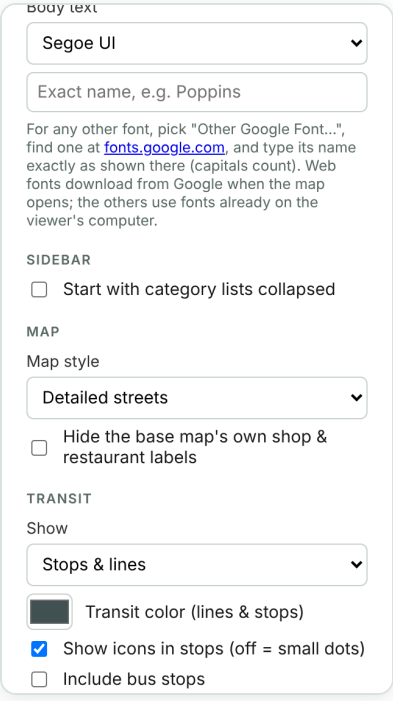
- **Layout:** *Sidebar menu*, or *Button menu* (category pills floating over a full-width map, each opening a compact list).
- **Title**, e.g. "384 Post Neighborhood," and an optional **logo**.
- **Color presets** from the CBRE palette, or set each color. Every color box offers the 15 brand swatches.

Categories

- Each category gets its own **pin color** automatically; click a swatch to change it.
- **Show category icons** puts icons in the pins and the list. Click an icon to **upload your own** (SVG or PNG with a transparent background). Only the shape is used, so it matches the set.

Fonts

- Pick a heading and body font, or choose **Other Google Font...** and type any name from fonts.google.com.



Map

- **Map style:** detailed streets, clean light gray, or bright.
- **Hide the base map's own shop & restaurant labels** so your pins are the only places on the map. Usually the cleanest look.

Transit

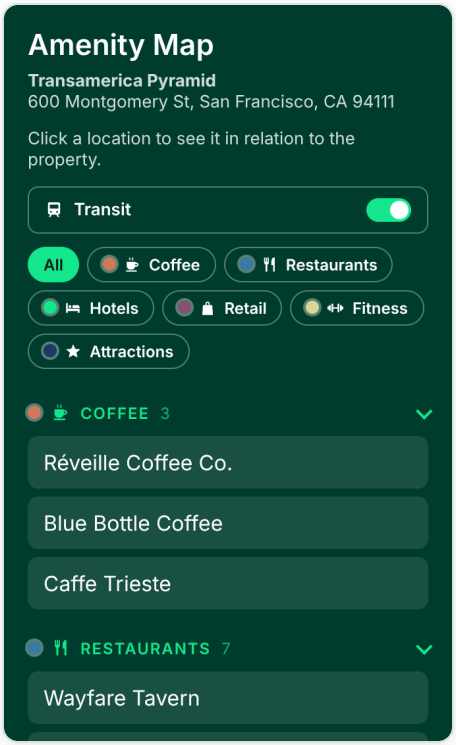
- **Show:** stops only, lines only, or both. Lines are train, subway, light rail and streetcar routes, not buses.
- **Transit color** for lines and stops.
- **Show icons in stops:** turn it off and stops become small dots that don't compete with your amenities.
- **Include bus stops** (they can be busy downtown).
- **Transit switch** lets viewers turn transit on and off themselves.

Sidebar

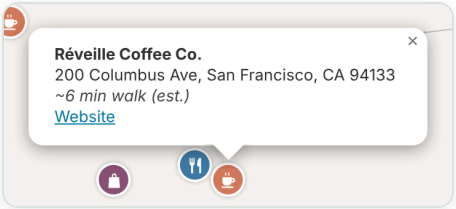
- **Start with category lists collapsed** keeps long maps tidy.

STEP 5

Save and share



What viewers see: a Transit switch, category filters and collapsible lists.



Hover a pin for its name; click for the address, walk time and website.

Save the shareable map

Click **Save shareable map (.html)**. You'll get a single file named after the property, with your data and look built in. When someone opens it:

- the editing tools are hidden and pins can't be moved;
- they can tap a **category chip** to isolate it (the map zooms to fit those places plus the property), collapse lists, hover and click pins, and toggle transit.

Ways to share it

- **Email:** zip the .html file first; Outlook often blocks .html attachments.
- **OneDrive / Box:** share the link. Viewers click *Download*, then open the file.
- **Property website (Vev):** paste the file's contents into an embed / custom-code element. The map fills its box, and is never shorter than 600px.

Downloads

- **Download CSV**: the full list, including any edits.
- **Download CSV for BAM 2.0**: BAM's column names, with your building marked "Subject Property."

Change a saved map later

Open the Map Maker and **drop the saved .html file into the upload box**. Everything comes back: places, edits, colors, icons, fonts, logo and transit settings. Make your changes and save again. Keep your saved file somewhere safe; it's your "project file."

> **Walk times** are estimates: straight-line distance plus 30% for the street grid, at about 3 mph. They're labeled "(est.)" in every popup.

BEFORE IT GOES OUT

Client-ready checklist

A polished map looks authoritative, so give it two minutes before you send it.

- [ ] **Spot-check pins.** Zoom in on a few. Do they sit on the right building? Drag any that don't.
- [ ] **Confirm places are still open,** especially anything from Copilot.
- [ ] **Click a few website links.** Remove any that don't go to the business's real site.
- [ ] **Check the property name and address** at the top of the sidebar.
- [ ] **Open the saved file once** before sending, to see exactly what the client will see.

Troubleshooting

The map looks different or the style options are grayed out.
This browser can't draw the detailed map (it needs WebGL), so it's showing the backup map. Everything else still works. Try another browser or computer. The note under the Map options explains it too.

Transit stops or lines don't show.
Zoom in: lines appear from neighborhood level and stops from street level. Also check that the sidebar's Transit switch is on.

Some places didn't appear.
They're missing coordinates or have invalid ones. The sidebar lists every skipped row by name; fix them in Edit data.

Accented names look garbled (CafÃ©).
Re-save from Excel as **CSV UTF-8**, then load it again.

"Search isn't available right now."
Your network blocked the place search. Click the map to place the pin instead.

A web font didn't load.
Some networks block Google Fonts. The map falls back to a standard font. To be safe, pick one of the fonts without "(web font)."

My categories split in two.
The spelling differs between rows ("Cafe" vs "Coffee"). Make them match in Edit data.



Questions, ideas, or a map that needs a custom touch?
Reach out to Lindsey at lindsey.huffman@cbre.com. Feedback from this pilot shapes what comes next.

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